

5.2 The Three-Tier Emotional Filter Framework

5.2.1 Excavation-to-Filter Mapping Reference

Pin this table beside your workspace. When you build each tier, glance here to know exactly which layers in your Chapter 3 profile to open.

Filter Tier	Draw From These Layers	What You Are Extracting
Baseline Emotional State	Layer Five (Core Wounds) + Layer Six (Aspirational Self-Image)	Default emotional temperature, management strategy, what happens when the management relaxes
Scene-Specific Trigger Response	Layer Four (Relational Triggers) + Layer Three (Emotional Defense Mechanisms)	How the voice shifts in stages when a specific trigger activates
Subtext Layer	Layer Seven (Hidden Contradictions) + Layer Five (Core Wounds)	The gap between spoken and meant, encoded as a divergence rule

5.2.2 Tier One: Baseline Emotional State Worksheet

Purpose: Define the character's default emotional temperature and the logic beneath it. This goes deeper than the Emotional Default field in your Dialogue Matrix by stating why the character defaults to that register and what the speech is managing.

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Guiding question if you stall: *What is this character managing every single moment, even when nothing is happening?*

Component	Your Entry
Default emotional state (name the feeling being managed):	[E.G., "Controlled vigilance masking low-grade fear of being seen as needy"]
Management strategy (how the speech contains the feeling):	[E.G., "Keep sentences short. Keep vocabulary blunt. Keep exchanges brief."]
What the voice is guarding / performing:	[E.G., "The character is guarding at rest. The bluntness is the guard."]

Component	Your Entry
What happens when the management relaxes:	[E.G., "Sentences lengthen. Vocabulary softens. The character becomes visibly uncomfortable with their own openness."]

5.2.3 Tier Two: Scene-Specific Trigger Response Worksheet

Purpose: Encode how the character's emotional state shifts in stages when a specific relational trigger activates. The voice must progress through at least two stages; a single flat shift produces static output.

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Component	Your Entry
The trigger (what happens in the scene):	[E.G., "The love interest asks a direct emotional question"]
Stage 1 – Immediate response (first one to two turns):	[E.G., "The guard intensifies. Sentences drop to under four words. Vocabulary narrows to monosyllables."]
Stage 2 – The leak (midexchange):	[E.G., "One microexpression of vulnerability leaks through—a trailing fragment, an unfinished sentence."]
Stage 3 – Recovery or escalation (final turns):	[E.G., "The guard reasserts. Subject changes within one turn." OR "The cheerfulness drops. One flat, quiet sentence arrives."]

Rule: If your trigger response reads as a single flat shift ("the character gets angry"), break it into stages. Name what happens first, what leaks through in the middle, and what arrives at the end. The AI needs the choreography, not the destination.

5.2.4 Tier Three: Subtext Layer Worksheet

Purpose: Encode the gap between what the character says and what the character means as a structural divergence rule the AI can execute.

Character: [CHARACTER_NAME]

Component	Your Entry
The divergence rule (direction and distance of the gap):	[E.G., "The spoken content is one emotional step removed from the felt content." OR "The spoken content is one emotional step brighter than the felt content."]

Component	Your Entry
Translation example 1 (felt → spoken):	[E.G., "If the character feels fear, he speaks irritation."]
Translation example 2 (felt → spoken):	[E.G., "If the character feels tenderness, he speaks efficiency."]
Delivery markers that make the gap audible (2–3 specific behaviors):	[E.G., "The clipped rhythm arrives one beat too late. The 'fine' lands flat. The subject change comes too quickly."]

If the subtext layer feels abstract: Return to Layer Seven of your excavation (Hidden Contradictions). The mask is the spoken content. The slip is the felt content. The gap between them is your subtext rule.